

Kanu Madhok

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Walmart Data Ventures

Chicago, IL · Sep 2024 – Present

Senior Data Analyst

- Designed and shipped to production a self-service analytics agent over 67 BigQuery tables with sub-agent orchestration and human-in-the-loop validation (Context Researcher → SQL Drafter → Validator → Devil's Advocate); 8 deterministic SQL rules and a 23-case golden-query evaluation suite. Partnered with Product, Data Science, and business stakeholders to translate ambiguous business questions into agent-ready specs. Approved by Sr. Director and product leadership and currently the only AI skill in active use by business teams on Data Ventures.
- Built a hybrid orchestrator on top of that agent so Product can self-serve analytics requests they previously filed as tickets. Routes questions through two backends in parallel — a CubeJS semantic-layer skill co-built with the DS and product team and the context-engineered agent — compares outputs, reasons about disagreements, and feeds discrepancies back to refine definitions over time. Converted 30–60 minutes of analyst execution per covered request into product-led self-service.
- Built and shipped an autonomous Jira ticket-resolution agent: 6-gate triage, MCP-driven context gathering, FAISS+BM25 retrieval over 11,000 historical SQL queries, self-healing execution with a 10-retry budget. Closed 400+ data requests across 8 categories over 15 months — cut turnaround from 30–60 minutes per request (up to a full day for complex ones) to under 10 minutes each. Stakeholders never knew an agent was answering them.
- Built a headless KPI monitor on a 6-hour cron that detects threshold breaches, runs root-cause analysis, and posts Slack alerts; state persists to BigQuery so the agent has no LLM-memory reliance. Designed a 3-tier event-driven v2 (reactive events, threshold KPIs, PM-owned themes) self-configuring via a BigQuery event registry — new event types ship without code deploys.
- Delivered 5 Power BI dashboards ranked top 1.4% of Walmart's 207,000 dashboards (1,064 views, 22 users); cut data-request turnaround from 1–24 hours to 5–10 minutes; Making a Difference Award.

University of Chicago — Data Science Institute

Chicago, IL · Jan – Sep 2024

Graduate Researcher, Data & Democracy Initiative

- Persona-driven multi-LLM (OpenAI + Gemini) conversational chatbot for a 500+ participant donation experiment; controlled A/B tests persuaded 15% to donate to an opposing cause.

FTI Consulting — UChicago MSADS Capstone

Chicago, IL · Jan – Aug 2024

- RAG-to-proposal generator deployed on AWS EC2 for a client engagement; cut proposal time ~30%; Best in Show — UChicago MSADS Capstone.

Innovare (EdTech Startup)

Chicago, IL · Oct 2022 – Mar 2023

Data Scientist

- Logistic-regression risk model + Looker dashboards for 10+ districts (5,000+ students); retention +7%, failures –15%.

SELECTED PROJECT

- Live deployed text-to-SQL copilot (Streamlit + Gemini 2.5 + RAG over historical queries, BigQuery execution, auto-visualization): live demo — <https://sql-rag-frontend-simple-481433773942.us-central1.run.app/>

SKILLS

Agent stack: MCP (Model Context Protocol) server design, sub-agent orchestration, context engineering, prompt engineering, RAG (FAISS + BM25 + RRF), evaluation suites (golden sets, human-in-the-loop validation), multi-model routing across providers, headless cron agents, event-driven architectures

LLMs: Claude (Opus / Sonnet / Haiku via Wibey), Gemini (2.5 Pro / Flash via Vertex AI), OpenAI

Partnering / delivery: stakeholder translation, agent-ready spec scoping with Product & Data Science, cross-functional execution across technical and non-technical teams

APIs / triggers / glue: FastAPI, Cloud Run, BigQuery scheduled queries, Slack webhooks, cron, Playwright SSO, JSONL state stores

Data: BigQuery, dbt, SQL, Python, PySpark, Airflow, Databricks, MySQL

EDUCATION

The University of Chicago — M.S., Applied Data Science (GPA 4.0)

Chicago, IL

Loyola University Chicago — B.S., Information Systems & Economics (GPA 3.5)

Chicago, IL